established principles of international law, which rely on human accountability for wartime conduct. Without clear responsibility, the moral and legal fabric of warfare could erode, leading to unregulated and potentially indiscriminate violence.

Another major concern is the potential for an AI-driven arms race. Nations investing heavily in autonomous combat drones risk destabilizing global security, as the proliferation of such systems could lower the threshold for armed conflict. Autonomous weapons may make war seem more politically and economically acceptable, as they reduce human losses, but this convenience could lead to more frequent and less constrained military engagements. Additionally, the risk of AI system hacking, spoofing, or malfunction poses significant threats to international peace and stability.

To address these issues, international organizations and humanitarian groups are advocating for the establishment of global treaties and ethical regulations governing autonomous weapons. The United Nations (UN), International Committee of the Red Cross (ICRC), and several member states have called for maintaining “Meaningful Human Control (MHC)” over all lethal decision-making processes. This principle ensures that humans remain the ultimate decision-makers in the authorization of lethal force, preserving moral judgment and accountability. Moreover, transparency in algorithm design, adherence to IHL, and global collaboration on AI ethics are being emphasized as prerequisites for responsible military AI development.

In essence, the integration of autonomous drones into warfare challenges the very foundations of human ethics, legality, and accountability. While these systems may enhance efficiency and reduce human exposure to danger, they also risk dehumanizing conflict and eroding moral